



Overview and Introduction to Business

Week 1

BUS500 – Foundations for Business Impact

Professor: Josh Peterson



COLLEGE OF BUSINESS
COLORADO STATE UNIVERSITY

A photograph of a tree-lined path on a university campus. The path is paved and leads into the distance, flanked by large, mature trees with vibrant yellow autumn foliage. A person is walking on the path in the distance. The scene is bright and sunny, with shadows cast on the grass.

Agenda

Welcome!

- Who am I?
- Who are you?

Course Overview

- Syllabus review
- Expectations

Business Basics

Business Communications

Organizational Design

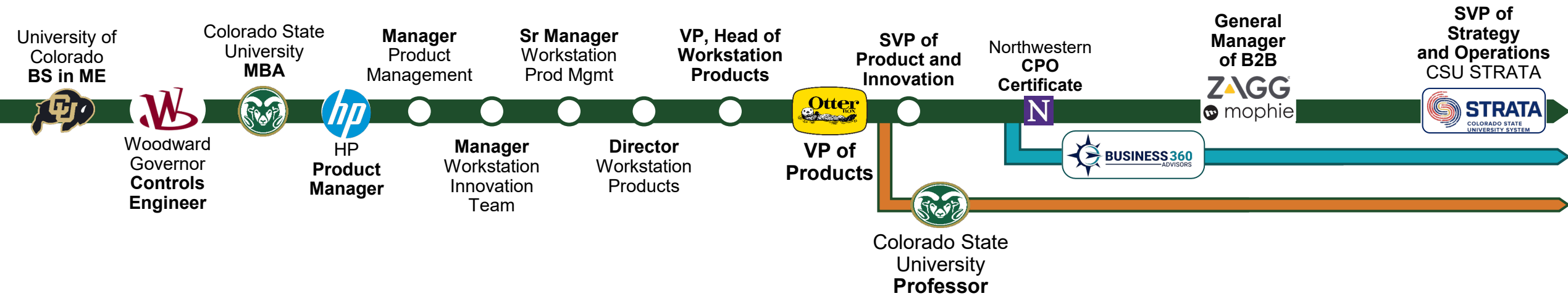
Homework Assignments



Who am I?

Josh Peterson

Adjunct Professor, CSU - College of Business



Who are you?

One Breath Introduction...

1. Name
2. What you do today (where you work, what your role is)
3. Something that makes you **happy** or **laugh**



Instructional Coordinators



Rod Thirion

Classroom and Lead IC

Rodney.Thirion@colostate.edu



Amy Walla

Online IC
(Pacific Time Zone)

Amy.Walla@colostate.edu



Scott Kinner

Online IC
(Eastern Time Zone)

Scott.Kinner@colostate.edu

- ✓ First point of contact for class-related questions or concerns (Email response within 24 hours)
- ✓ Grading all assignments and exams (within 1 week of due date)
- ✓ Use them but do not abuse them 😊
- ✗ IT/Tech or Library Support



Email Examples

Bad Email

I'm a little shaky on this week's topic. Can you take a look at my assignment and tell me if I did it right?

Another Bad one

As I'm going through the homework assignment for this week, I have some questions.

- 1) *Where does rent go?*
- 2) *Where does interest go?*
- 3) *How do I do the third part of the assignment?*



Email Examples

Good Email

As I'm going through the homework assignment for this week I have some questions. But first a bit of background on what I've done so far...

- 1) Would rent be considered a current liability? Or would rent not be included on the Balance Sheet and would be only found on the Income Statement as an expense? We are a month-to-month rental agreement so I don't feel it would fit into a long-term liability. My initial thought is that this would not be included on the balance sheet.*
- 2) Would interest earned on investments be only found on the Cash Flow Statement under ICF?*
- 3) For the third part of the assignment, here's what I think I'm supposed to do, here's what is unclear to me...*



Syllabus Review

The goal of BUS 500 is to give you a sound business understanding and starting point you can leverage and build upon in your academic business courses





BUS500 – Foundations for Business Impact



Business for a Better World

Business Ethics

Innovation

Company Culture

Corporate Social Responsibility



Course Outline

Week 1

**Business
Overview**

Week 2

**Business
Models /
Innovation**

Week 3

Strategy

Week 4

**Marketing /
Culture**

**Supply Chain /
CSR**

Week 5

**Economics /
Value Chain**

Week 6

**Finance /
Entrepreneurship**

Week 7

Leadership

Week 8



Reading Material

Readings	Where to acquire
From Good Ideas to Great Results: How to Speak Business and Make an Impact by Josh Peterson	Canvas – Module 1
The Five Competitive Forces that Shape Strategy by Michael Porter (Jan 2008)	Electronic Reserves CSU Library (Instructions for accessing will be provided on Canvas) NOTE: Due to copyright restrictions, these readings will not be available until the first official day of class.
Marketing Strategy – An Overview by Raymond Corey (Mar 2003)	
Analysis without Paralysis: Chapter 13 – Value Chain Analysis by B. Bensoussan and C. Fleisher	
Leadership That Gets Results by Daniel Goleman	
Harvard Business Course Pack: - Stop the Innovation Wars - H&M in China	<u>SEE SYLLABUS FOR CURRENT LINK</u> NOTE: You will need to set up an account and purchase these readings.
<u>Managing by the Numbers</u> by Kremer and Rizzuto (ISBN: 978-0-7382-0256-3)	CSU Bookstore, Amazon
<u>Leading with Vision</u> by Hagemann, Vetter, and Maketa (ISBN: 9781473696068)	

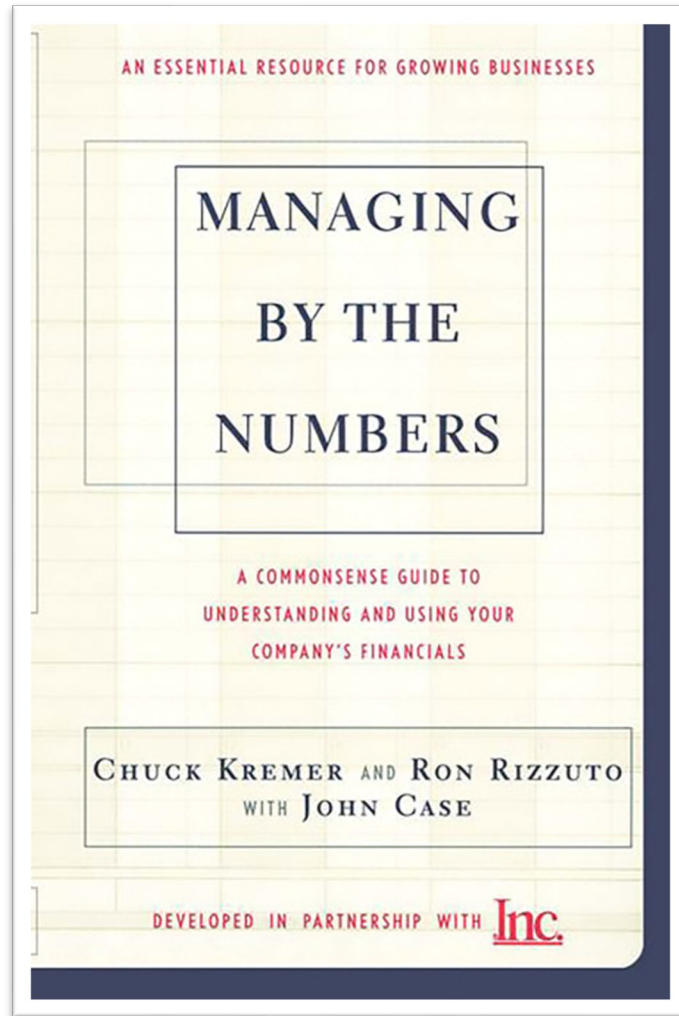
Required

Recommended



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Reading Material

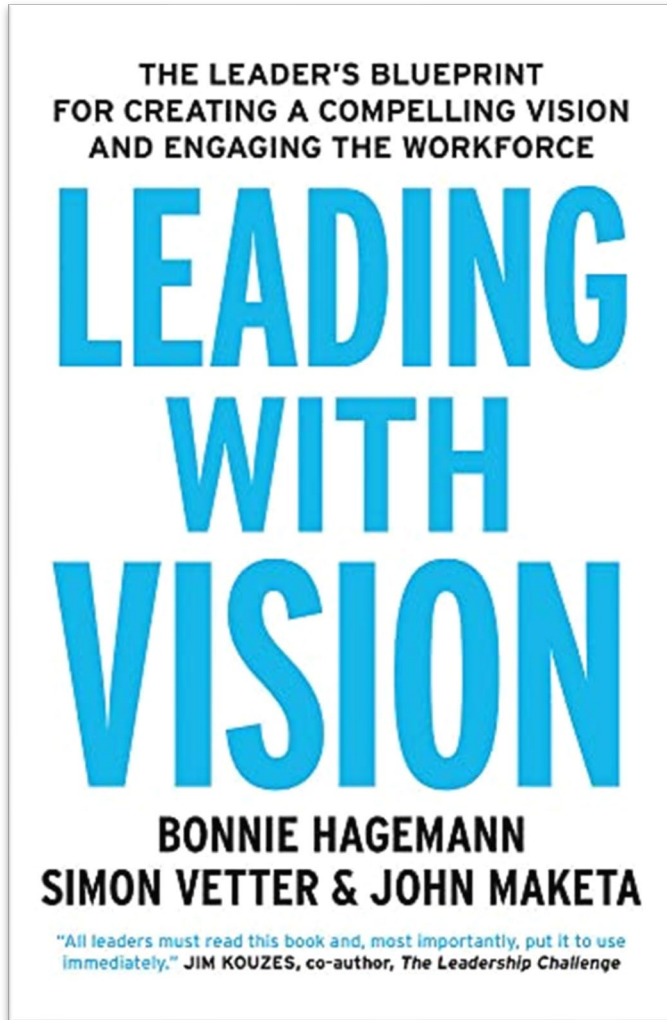


Managing by the Numbers by Kremer and Rizzuto

Only Chapters 1-10

Available for purchase at CSU Bookstore or Amazon

Reading Material



Leading with Vision

by Hagemann, Vetter, and Maketa

Only Chapters 1-6

Available for purchase at CSU Bookstore or Amazon

Reading Material



<http://www.accessnyt.com/>

<https://biz.colostate.edu/information-for/wsj>

Course Deliverables and Points

Learning Activity	Max Points	%
Pre-Class Assignments (1x30)	30	3%
Assignments (6x80)	480	48%
Quizzes (6X15)	90	9%
Exams (2x160)	320	32%
Participation (8x20)	80	8%
TOTAL	1000	100%

Points Earned	Grade
934 -1000	A
900 - 933	A-
867 - 899	B+
800 - 866	B
767 - 799	C+
700 - 766	C
600 - 699	D
< 600	F



Assignments

- There will be six assignments due throughout the 8 weeks
 - One assignment due each week except for midterm and finals week
 - A single template will be used for many of the initial assignments
- **Class examples are more simplified than typical assignment submissions**
 - Assignments with the highest depth and detail will receive the best grades
 - Grading is relative to other submissions
- Grading criteria:
 - Assignment requirements/rubric
 - Quality, Application of Concepts, Critical Thinking, Practicality, Mechanics, and **Wow**
 - Original work

Quizzes and Exams

- Quizzes (6) and Exams (2) all require the use of the Respondus LockDown Browser
 - This must be downloaded and installed on your PC, Mac, or iPad
 - Once you've launched the quiz/exam within the lockdown browser, you'll be unable to access other applications, other websites, or content on your PC until you've submitted the quiz/exam
- Practice quiz (optional and ungraded) is available to test it out before you launch an official quiz or exam
- Quizzes and Exams are timed and must be submitted within the stated time limit (Timer starts upon opening the quiz/exam)



Discussion Topics (Online students)

- There will be four discussion assignments throughout the 8 weeks
 - In week 1 of each discussion, you will be asked to either post a relevant business article and/or discuss a topic that you have been prompted
 - In week 2 of the discussion, you will comment or contribute to two of your classmates' discussion posts.
- Assignments will be graded based on quality of the post as well as connection back to applicable class content
 - Clarity of writing will be important, including correct spelling and grammar
 - Pay attention to the wordcount requirements



Online Students

- Online students are welcome to attend one class in person or watch livestream (during 1st 8 weeks of the fall session)
 - If there are issues with the livestream, contact Lead IC: Rodney.Thirion@colostate.edu
- Students taking the course after the 1st 8 weeks of Fall 2024 **need to read weekly updates for specific dates and changes to the course.**
- Videos generally posted by noon on the day following class (by 9pm MT at the latest)
- Online students are encouraged to network and build relationships with other online students



Just in Case...

- If On-Campus Students are sick...
 - Don't come to class! Become a MOSAIC student for that week...
 - Communicate serious illness to your IC
- If I am sick...
 - Instructions will be sent out to the students with plans for the week
 - We may move class online for the week (including on-campus students)
- ALWAYS Check communications regularly (emails and Canvas)



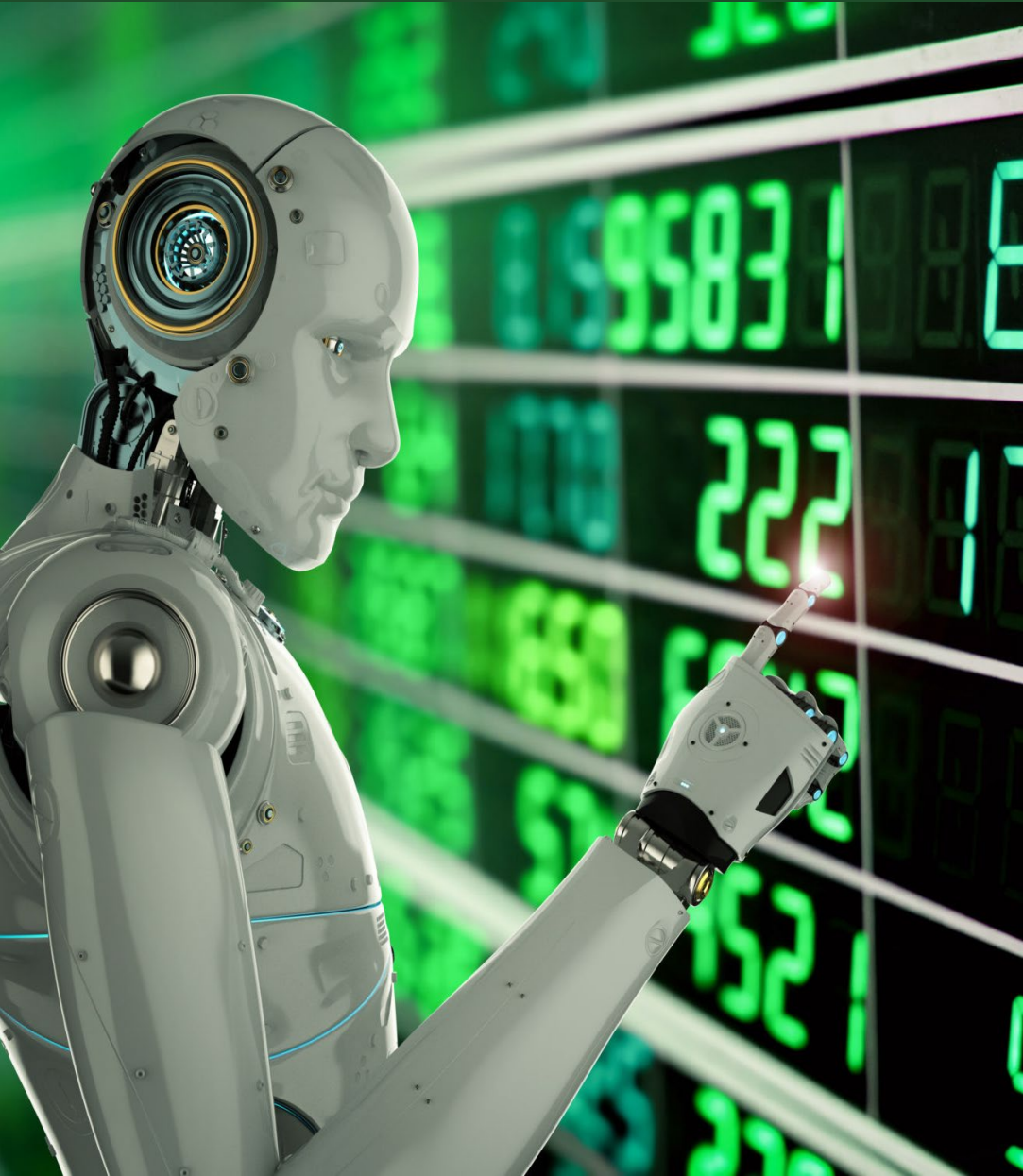


How to be successful in BUS500

- Come to class on time, and in appropriate attire
- Please bring and display your Name Tents
- Complete pre-reading before class / before watching the class videos
- Participate actively in class discussions; ask questions, share thoughts, challenge, be respectful (but don't monopolize discussions)
- Keep up with all assignments, late work is penalized
- Slides will be posted no later than 5:00pm MT day of class – consider taking notes on them
- MOSAIC: Raise you hand in front of camera to get my attention
- PROACTIVELY communicate with your IC



Artificial Intelligence Discussion



- How familiar are you with AI?
- Evolution of Tools
- My Philosophy (which has evolved)
- Caveats
 - [ChatGPT Lawyer Case](#)
 - Context, Sources, Spatial Awareness, Hallucinations
- Goals for AI
- Guidelines and Restrictions
- Additional Reading (optional)
 - [“On holding back the strange AI tide”](#)
 - [“AI Will Not Replace You, People Using AI Will”](#)
 - [“Automating creativity”](#)



What Is Meant by "AI Fluency"

AI Fluency Means:

Knowing what AI is good at

Knowing what AI is bad at

Knowing when not to use it

Being able to evaluate and challenge outputs

AI fluency $\neq$ prompt cleverness or lengthy professional-sounding output

AI fluency = acceleration through critical evaluation + responsible application

In this course, AI is expected.

Blind reliance is penalized, not rewarded.

The Responsible AI Lens

Applying the 4Ds of AI Fluency across everything we do

DELEGATION

Should AI do this?

Before each DT stage, ask: what tasks genuinely benefit from AI? What requires human judgment, empathy, or creativity? Be strategic, not just efficient.

DESCRIPTION

How do I direct AI well?

Quality prompts drive quality output. Invest in describing context, constraints, and goals clearly. Iteration is the process. Your prompt quality improves with practice.

DISCERNMENT

Is this output good?

AI can hallucinate, oversimplify, or reflect bias. Always evaluate outputs critically, for accuracy, relevance, and whether it actually serves your users.

DILIGENCE

Am I being responsible?

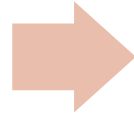
Cite AI use. Verify claims. Consider privacy. Own the work. You are accountable for everything you submit, present, or ship, regardless of how it was made.



The Responsible AI Workflow

AI works best when used **between human thinking steps**, not instead of them.
AI should amplify human reasoning, not replace it.

Human
Insight



AI
Exploration



Human
Judgement

Humans bring:

- goals and intent
- domain knowledge
- ethical judgment
- understanding of real-world context

Without human direction, AI produces **generic or irrelevant output**.

Key Question

What problem are we trying to solve?

AI is useful for:

- generating alternatives
- organizing large amounts of information
- identifying patterns
- stress-testing ideas
- summarizing and synthesizing content

AI accelerates **exploration** and **pattern discovery**

Humans evaluate and refine the results, by deciding:

- what is useful
- what is appropriate
- what is credible
- what is ethical
- what is practical

AI helps expand **options**.
Humans make **decisions**.

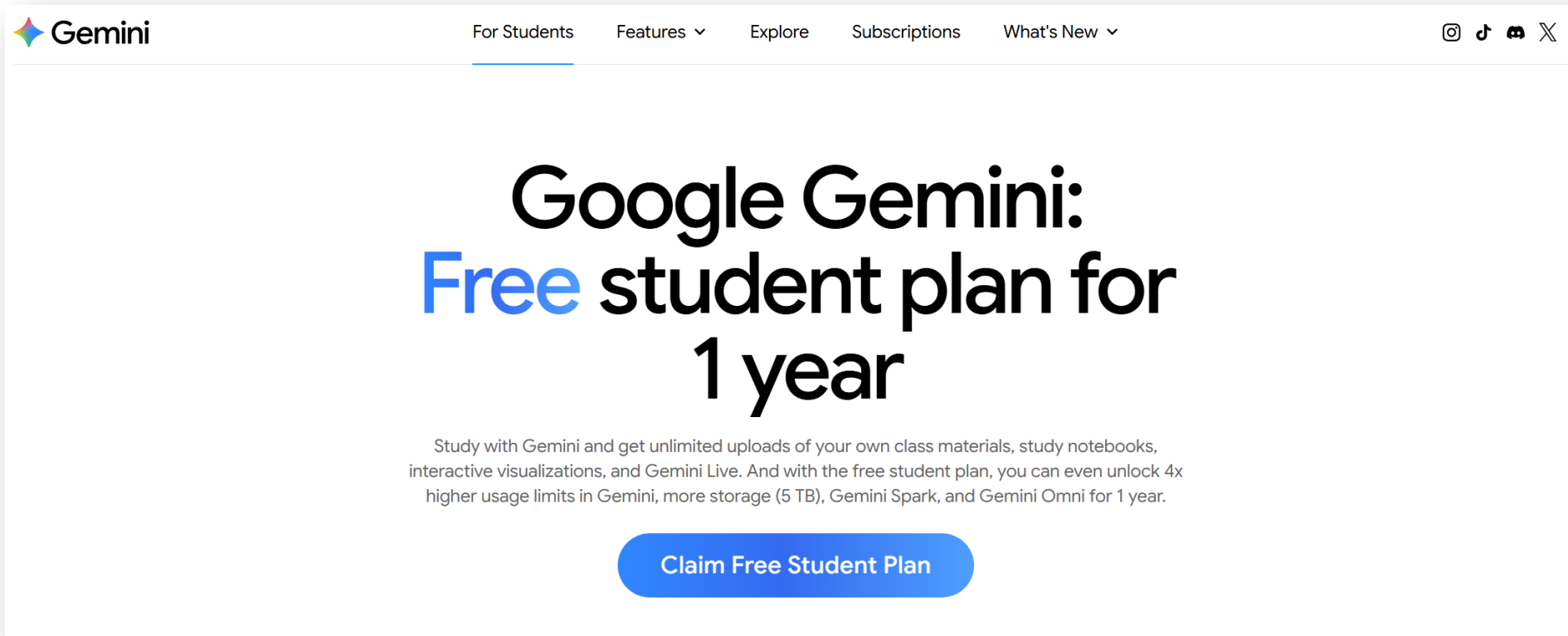


Artificial Intelligence Guidelines and Restrictions

SPECIFIC ONLY TO BUS500

OK / Encouraged	Prohibited
• Tutoring / Study Buddy • Reading Partner • Idea Collaborator • Proofreader (of your original work)	• Raw Copy and Paste from tool into graded assignment (will be considered plagiarism) • Use during Quizzes or Exams (will be considered violation of CSU's Academic Integrity policy)
Required for AI use	
• Cite any content created by generative AI and share the 'final' prompts that you used • Avoid quotes/data that cannot be traced back to original source • Provide short "AI Reflection" paragraph	

AI Offer from Google / Gemini



The screenshot shows the Gemini website's 'For Students' page. At the top, the Gemini logo is on the left, and navigation links for 'For Students', 'Features', 'Explore', 'Subscriptions', and 'What's New' are in the center. Social media icons for Instagram, TikTok, Discord, and X are on the right. The main heading reads 'Google Gemini: Free student plan for 1 year', with 'Free' in blue. Below this, a paragraph describes the benefits: 'Study with Gemini and get unlimited uploads of your own class materials, study notebooks, interactive visualizations, and Gemini Live. And with the free student plan, you can even unlock 4x higher usage limits in Gemini, more storage (5 TB), Gemini Spark, and Gemini Omni for 1 year.' A blue button labeled 'Claim Free Student Plan' is centered at the bottom.

Google Gemini:
Free student plan for
1 year

Study with Gemini and get unlimited uploads of your own class materials, study notebooks, interactive visualizations, and Gemini Live. And with the free student plan, you can even unlock 4x higher usage limits in Gemini, more storage (5 TB), Gemini Spark, and Gemini Omni for 1 year.

[Claim Free Student Plan](#)

Eligible students only. [Offer Terms](#) apply. Redeem until December 31, 2026. Valid form of payment required at sign-up. Unless cancelled earlier, Google AI Pro will automatically charge \$19.99/month after the trial ends. Cancel anytime.

<https://gemini.google/students/>



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AI Offer from OpenAI / ChatGPT



Student offer

Study. Build. Launch.
Get 4 months of
ChatGPT Work on us.

An \$80 value for eligible U.S. college students. Claim by
October 31.

Claim free offer



https://chatgpt.com/students/claim?campaign=students_2026



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Dear Self: Quit Doing The Bare Minimum

Entrepreneur

Dear Self: Quit Doing the Bare Minimum.

If you want satisfying rewards, you have to put in maximum effort.

By [William Harris](#) January 27, 2020

Opinions expressed by Entrepreneur contributors are their own.

You wouldn't want your mechanic doing the bare minimum required to make your family car safe to drive. You wouldn't want your surgeon doing the bare minimum needed to keep your heart pumping. You wouldn't want the chef at your favorite restaurant doing the bare minimum to ensure the food you're eating is safe to consume.



AleksandarNakic | Getty Images

“Am I proud of this?”

Act like your reputation
depends on it.

Work for the role you want.

Treat every day like it's your
last.

"Because I went through the motions, I now deserve a reward."

"Hey, so if I start showing up to work on time, do you think I can get a raise?"



Questions About the Class?



Business Basics

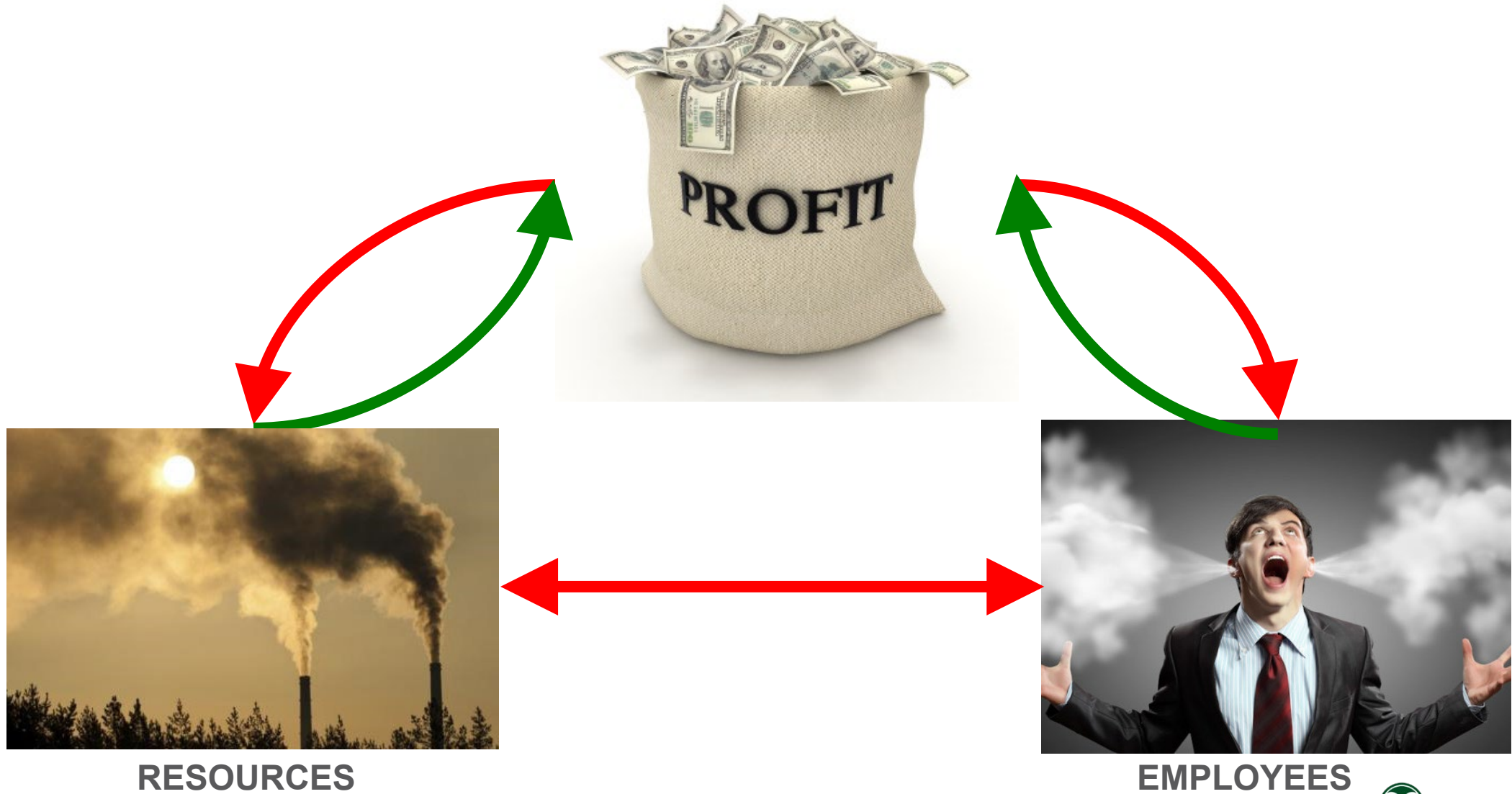


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Business Purpose

- What is the purpose of business?
- As a business, what are your goals?
- What is the #1 Goal of Business?

Traditional Bottom Line





Triple Bottom Line





What's the difference?



VALUES

• Who we are (ethics, principles, and beliefs)

MISSION

- Why we exist

"Offer a wide range of well-designed, functional home furnishing products at prices so low that as many people as possible will be able to afford them."

VISION

- Where we are headed

"To create a better everyday life for the many people."

GOALS

- Broad outcomes we need to achieve along the way

Offer the lowest prices on comparable products in our industry

STRATEGY

- How we will get where we're going

Reduce our costs through scale and technology

OBJECTIVE

- Measurable step we take to support the strategy

Reduce shipping and logistics costs by 10% in 2026

TACTICS

- Specific actions we'll take to achieve an objective

Hold a reverse auction for 2026 logistics suppliers



GSOT Practice



VALUES

• Who we are (ethics, principles, and beliefs)

MISSION

- Why we exist

“Create groundbreaking sports innovations, make our products sustainably, build a creative and diverse global team, and make a positive impact in communities where we live and work.”

VISION

- Where we are headed

“Bring inspiration and innovation to every athlete* in the world.”
**if you have a body, you are an athlete*

GOALS

- Broad outcomes we need to achieve along the way

Become the leading sustainable performance athletic brand (broad outcome toward Nike's vision of inspiring every athlete)

STRATEGY

- How we will get where we're going

Prove that sustainable materials can deliver superior athletic performance, making eco-consciousness an athletic advantage rather than a compromise

OBJECTIVE

- Measurable step we take to support the strategy

Launch a 100% recycled running shoe that achieves 15% better performance metrics than current models and captures 10% market share within 12 months

TACTICS

- Specific actions we'll take to achieve an objective

- Partner with 3 material science companies by Q1 to develop recycled composites
- Recruit 50 elite athletes to test prototypes and provide performance feedback

GSOT Practice



VALUES

• Who we are (ethics, principles, and beliefs)

MISSION

- Why we exist

"We strive to offer our customers the lowest possible prices, the best available selection, and the utmost convenience."

VISION

- Where we are headed

"We are the Earth's most customer-centric company, where customers can find and discover anything they might want to buy online."

GOALS

- Broad outcomes we need to achieve along the way

STRATEGY

- How we will get where we're going

OBJECTIVE

- Measurable step we take to support the strategy

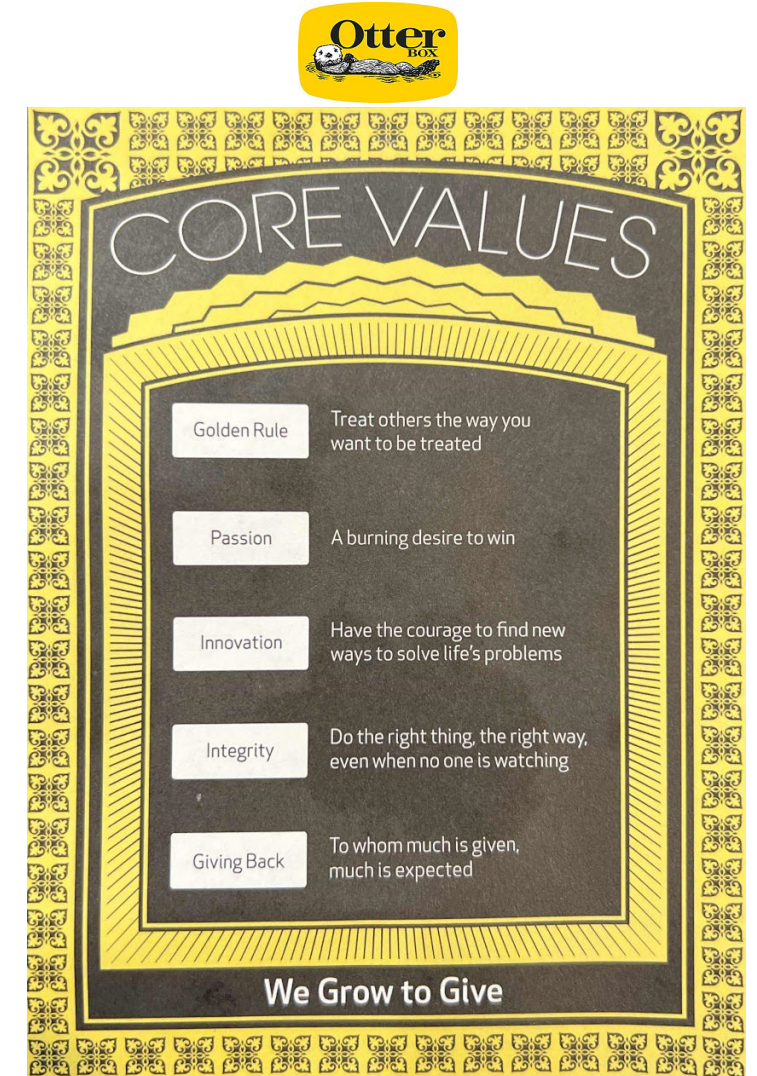
TACTICS

- Specific actions we'll take to achieve an objective



Establishing the Company Values

1. Utilize a small group of thought leaders from various levels across the company (include the CEO and/or founders)
 - NOTE: This is not an all-employee, consensus driven process!
2. Consider the existing team and culture to inform the process
3. Brainstorm qualities that the company embodies in an authentic way
4. Combine and consolidate overlapping or similar qualities
5. Allow time for reflection and consideration
6. Narrow the list to the core... not too many, not too few... (~5)
7. Simple and easy-to-remember, but define each in detail
8. Communicate to all employees
9. Live and exemplify them everyday
10. Revisit and evolve as necessary





Establishing the Mission Statement

1. What is our business?

2. How are we doing it?

3. For whom are we doing it?

4. What are our core values?



“To inspire and nurture the human spirit—one person, one cup, and one neighborhood at a time.”

1. **What is their business?:** “One cup,” i.e., Starbucks is a retailer of coffee.
2. **How are they doing it?:** Starbucks prioritizes every customer and their community in everything it does.
3. **Whom do they serve?:** You and your community.
4. **What are their core values?:** To inspire and nurture the human spirit.



Establishing the Vision Statement

1. Project five to ten years into the future
2. Dream big, be bold, and focus on success
3. Use the present tense
4. Use clear, concise, jargon-free language – shorter is better
5. Infuse it with passion and make it inspiring
6. Speak to the employees
7. Align it with your business values and mission
8. Create a plan to communicate the vision statement to all employees



“Disney is one of the world's leading producers and providers of entertainment and information.”



“Starbucks is the premier purveyor of the finest coffee in the world while maintaining our uncompromising principles while we grow.”



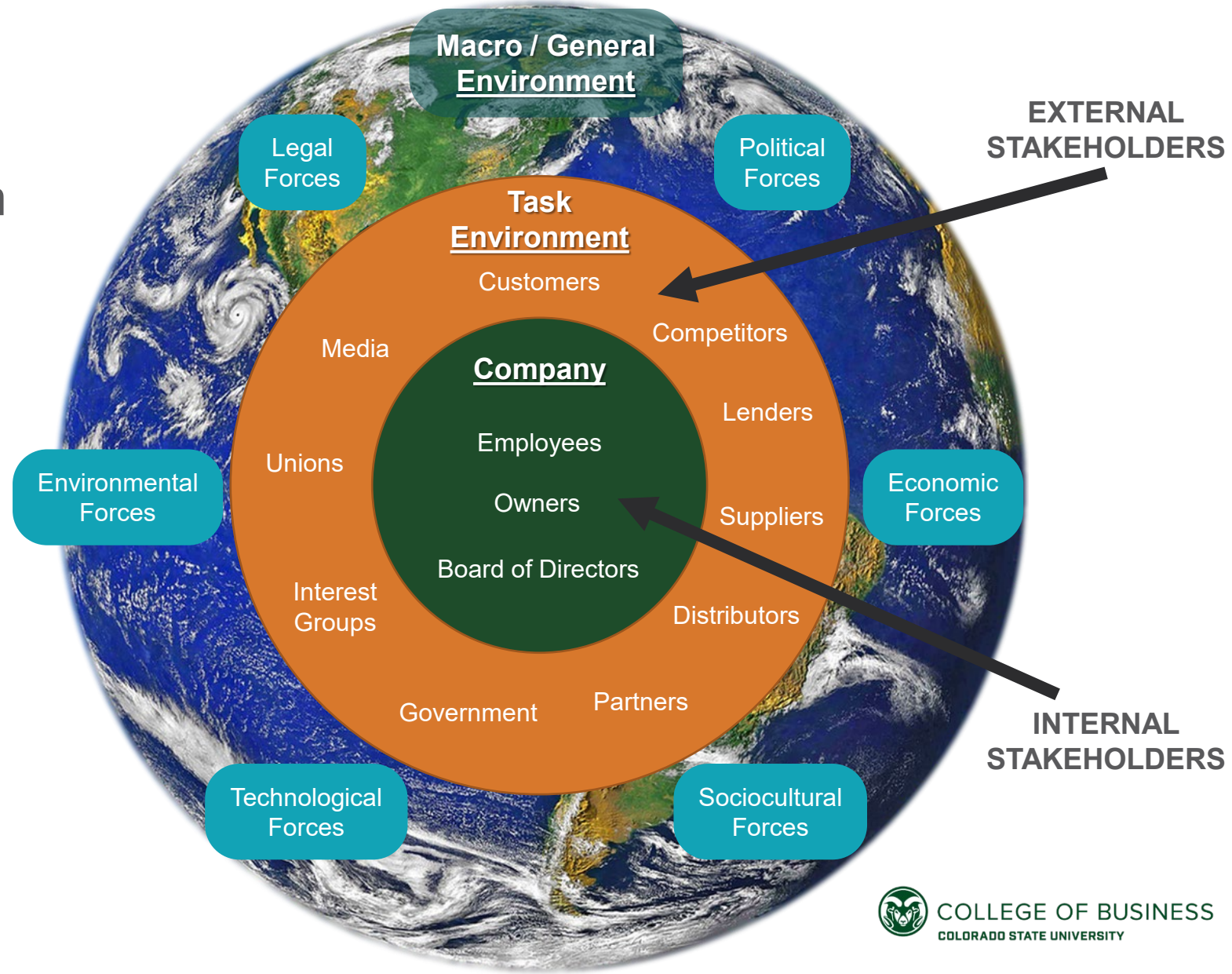
The Community of Stakeholders

Stakeholders

are the groups or people that can affect or are affected by an organization's activities.

Shareholders

are the groups or people that own all or a portion of a business.



Organizational Stakeholders



Business Communications



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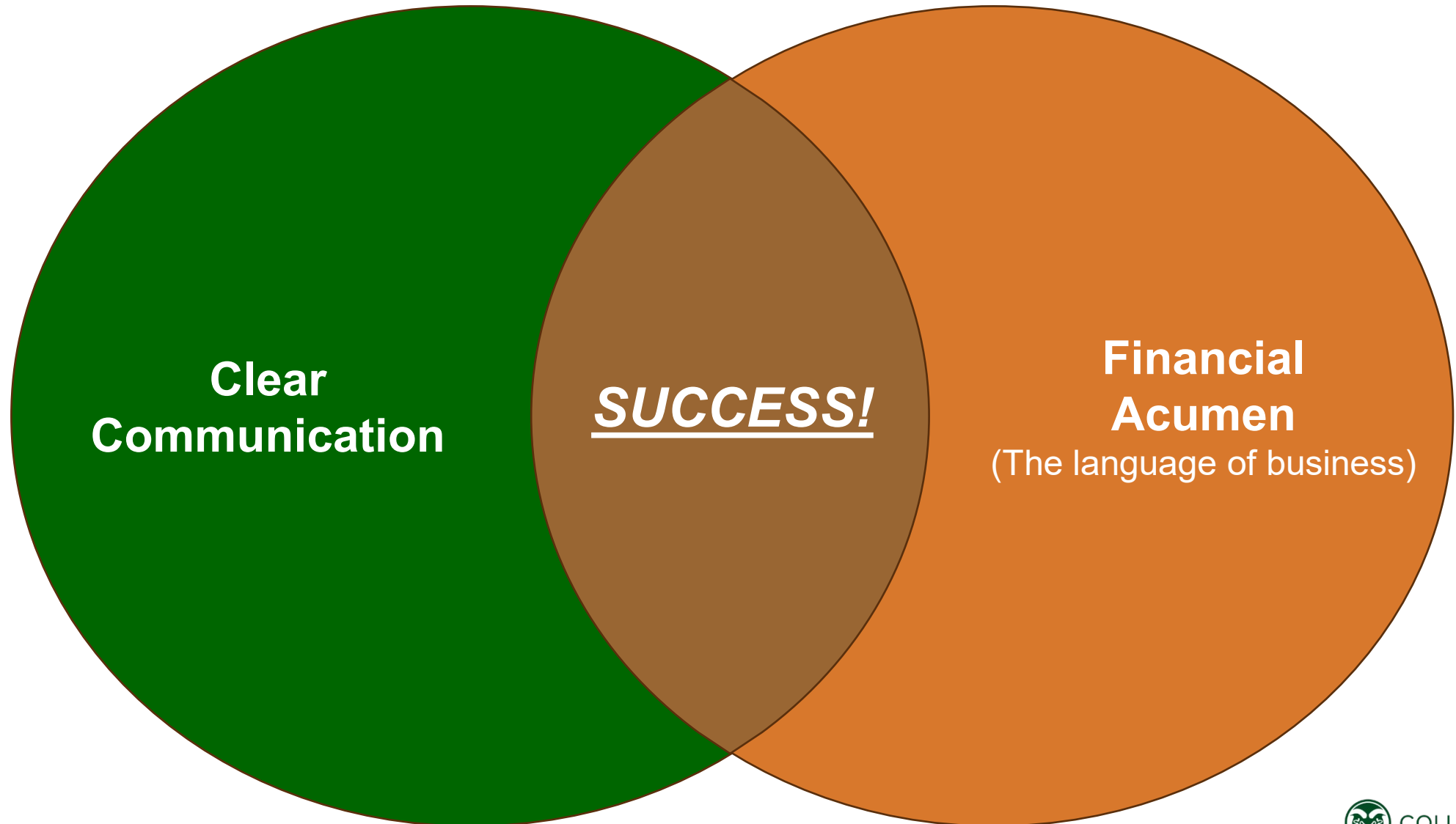
Reading Material



From Good Ideas to Great Results: How to Speak Business and Make an Impact by Josh Peterson

Why is this topic important?

Two essential skills to succeed in business...



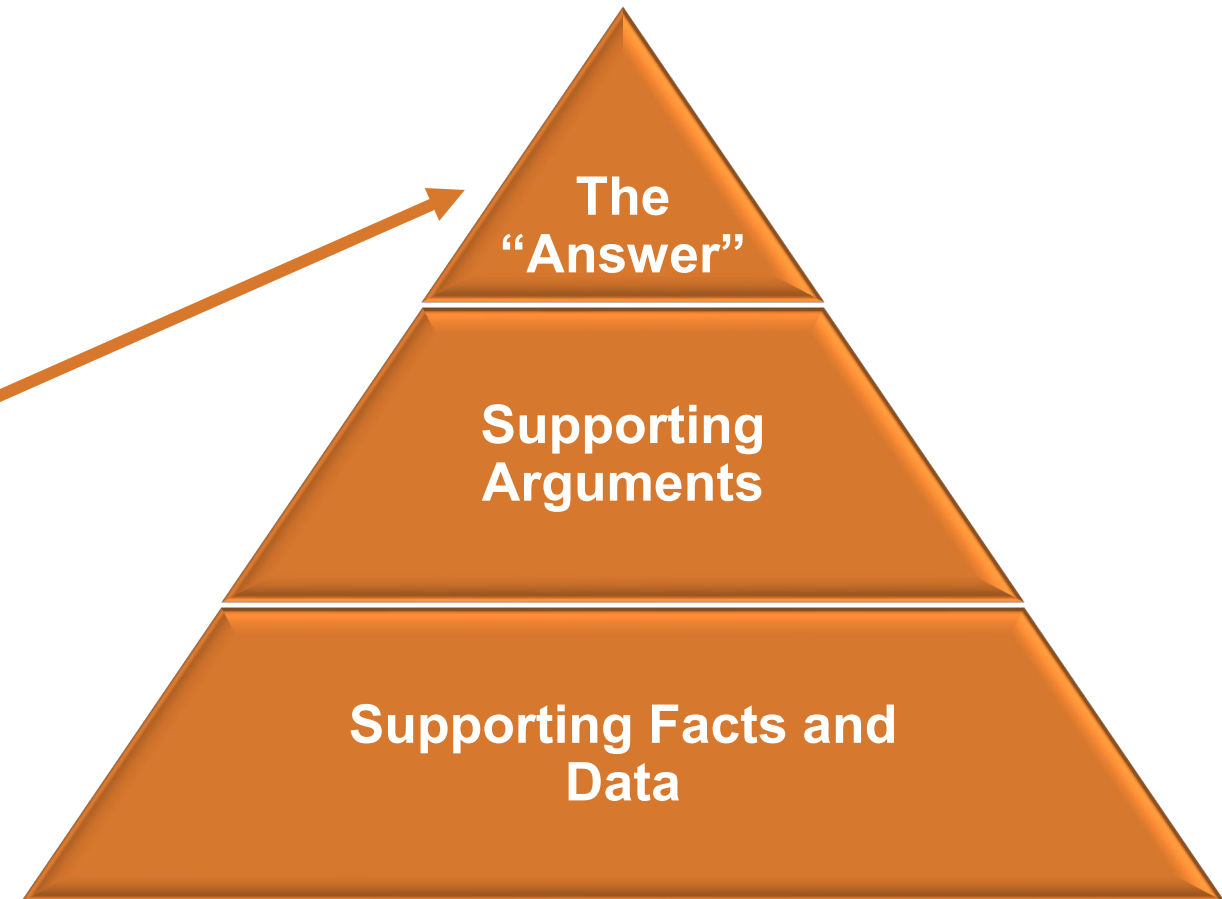
Pyramid Principle

Discovery

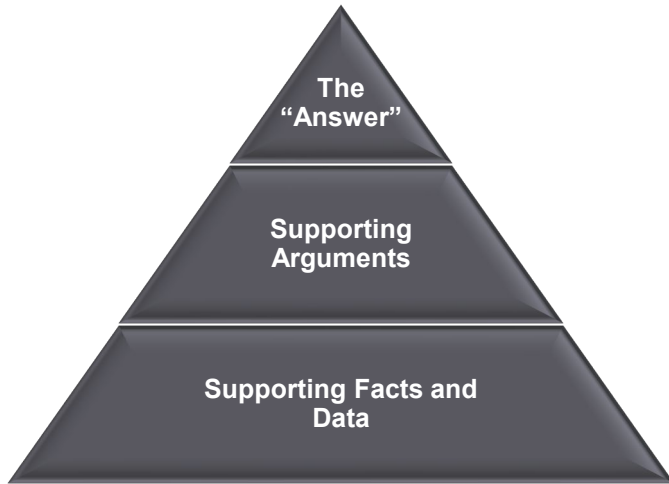
- **S**ituation: What is the issue?
- **C**omplication: Why are you even addressing this issue?
- **Q**uestion: What are you trying to figure out?
- **A**nswer: What is the solution you're proposing?

KEY: Tie your arguments and supporting data to business impact

Communication



Making Your Ideas Stick...



SIMPLE

Find the Core

UNEXPECTED

Get & Keep Attention

CONCRETE

Make it Clear

CREDIBLE

Make People Believe

EMOTIONAL

Make People Care

STORIES

Get People To Act & Remember

Structure + Stickiness = Ideas That Drive Action



Every Role is a Financial Role



Before
“Improve Thermal Management”
After
“Save \$180k/year in warranty costs”

Technical Expertise + Financial Lens = Executive Approval

The Language of Business

- Businesses run on 'financial logic'
 - To manage and influence you must think and communicate in this 'language'
- Prerequisites needed to communicate effectively:
 - Understand how company makes \$\$ (basic P&L knowledge)
 - Understand external influences (task and macro) and context
 - Macro Environment:
 - PESTEL model (political, economic, social, technological, environmental, legal)
 - Unidirectional Influence
 - Task Environment:
 - External stakeholders (Customers, Suppliers, Partners, Competitors, Media, etc)
- Express your ideas/suggestions in financial terms



Your strategic partner... AI

AI excels at...	Humans essential for...
• Brainstorming • Structure refinement • Draft creation • Grammar checking 	• Strategic decisions • Company culture • Relationship building • Final accountability 



Beware of Pitfalls

(confidential information, hallucinations, misinformation, etc)



Poor / Baseline Email Example

Hi Mark,

I wanted to follow up on some of the conversations we've been having about customer onboarding. I've been looking into the process and talking with several members of the team, and it seems like there may be some opportunities for improvement.

As you know, onboarding has been a challenge for a while, and there are a number of different factors contributing to it. Customers sometimes get frustrated with how long things take, and the customer success team is spending quite a bit of time helping customers through the process.

I've looked at several options, including some potential process changes, additional automation, and changes to how the team handles new customers. There would obviously be some costs involved, but I think the improvements could ultimately help customer satisfaction and make the team more efficient.

I put together some additional information and would be interested in getting your thoughts. Maybe we can find some time to discuss?

Thanks,
Sarah



Sarah's Success: Integration in Action

1. SCQA Analysis / Pyramid Principle

“Take onboarding from 45 days → 10 days”

2. SUCCESS Application

Story plus Concrete Metrics

3. Financial Case

“\$225k investment → \$1.6M returns”

4. AI Enhancement

Research & Refinement

5. RESULT

Approved & Promoted



Better / Email Example Applying These Principles

Hi Mark,

I recommend we invest \$225K to redesign our customer onboarding process, reducing average onboarding time from 45 days to approximately 10 days.

Today, 15% of new customers request refunds during onboarding, representing roughly \$1.7M in lost annual revenue. Our customer success team also spends 60% of its time managing onboarding rather than supporting customer growth.

By streamlining and automating the process, we estimate we can reduce refunds to 5%, free significant team capacity, and generate approximately \$1.6M in annual financial benefit. Even if we achieve only half of the projected improvement, the investment pays for itself in less than six months.

I've attached the analysis and implementation plan. Could we spend 30 minutes reviewing the recommendation this week?

Thanks,
Sarah



Business Terminology – General Terms

Elevator Pitch

Shareholders

B2B

B2C

Brick and Mortar

Benchmarking

Differentiation

Due Dilligence

Time To Market

Bandwidth

Market Share

CRM

Deliverable

SWOT

Share of Wallet

Triple Bottom Line

Pegs/Assortment

KPI

Connect Rate/Attach Rate

B Corp

Stakeholders

Metrics

Demographics

Green Washing





Business Terminology – Financial Terms

ROI	Assets	ASP	Channel Margin
Gross	Liabilities	MSRP	Operating Profit
Net	Equity	Wholesale Price	Overhead
Accounts Payable	Revenue	OPEX	Fixed Costs
Accounts Receivable	Top Line	COGS	Variable Costs
Capital	Bottom Line	Gross Margin	Monetize



Organization Design



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Organization Design

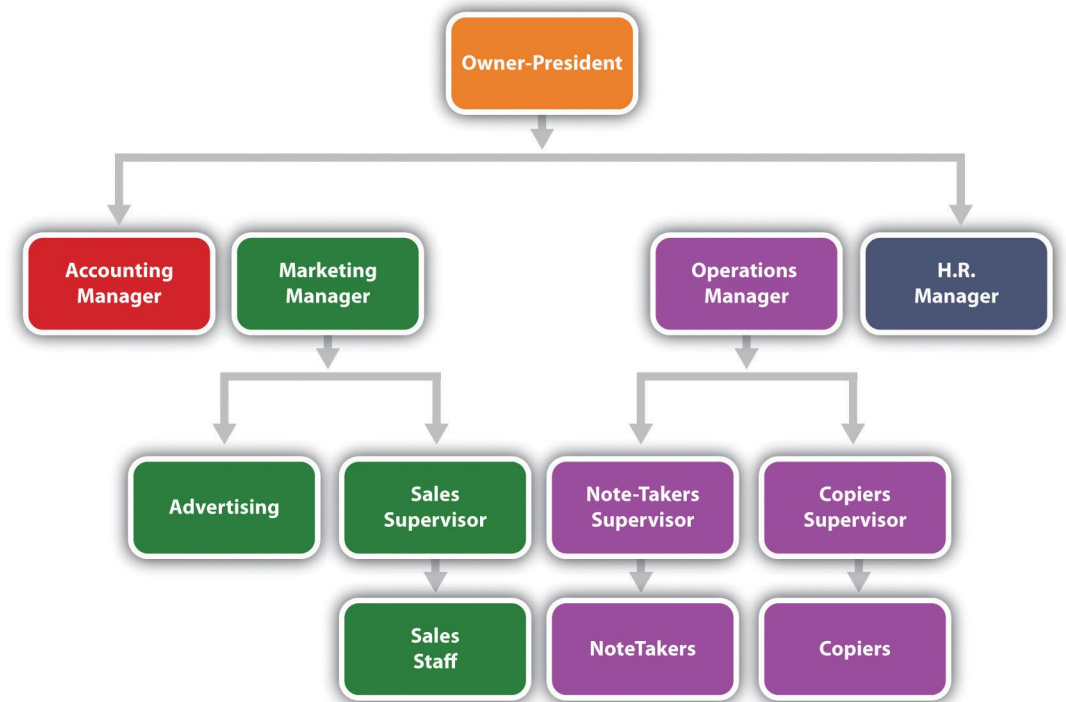
- Organization Design:
 - Process for shaping the way companies or organizations are structured and how they run
 - “Form follows function” – Design (and redesign) your organization to support your strategy and dynamics of your business

Impact of good organization design?	Impact of poor organization design?
?	?



Organization Structure / Terminology

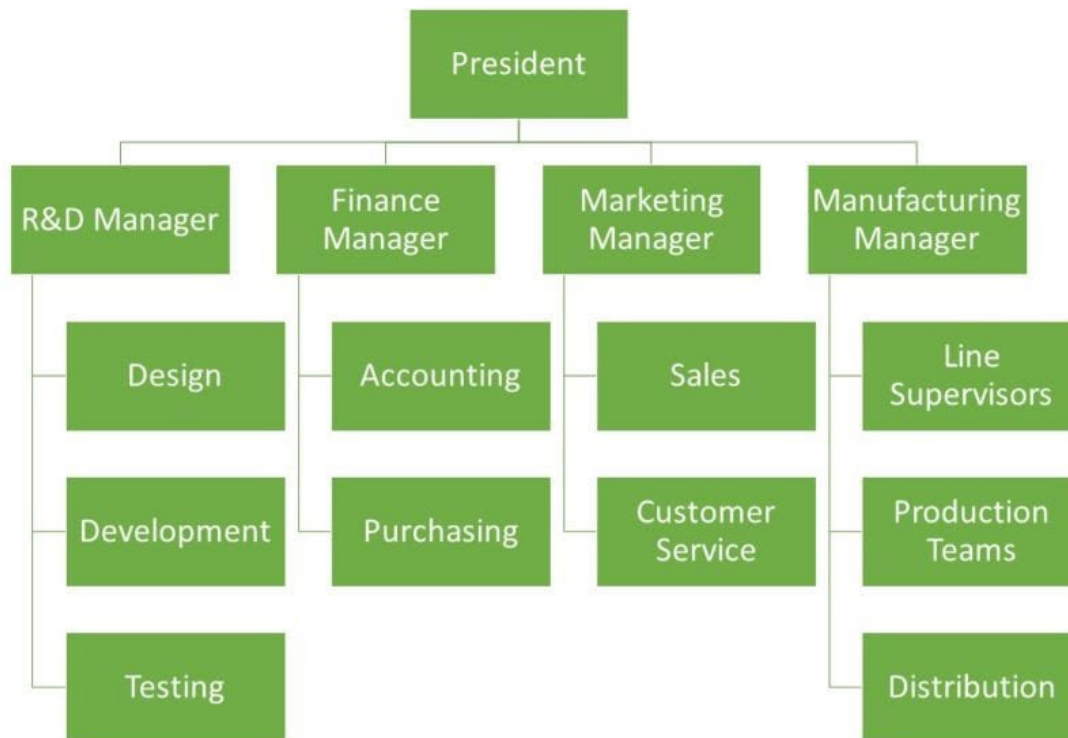
- Organization Structure Types:
 - Functional Structure (*aka Hierarchical*)
 - Divisional Structure
 - Matrix Structure
 - Flat Organization Structure
- Organization Terminology
 - Chain of Command
 - Span of Control
 - Subordinates
 - Direct Report vs. Dotted-Line
 - Dual Report
 - Bandwidth
 - Burst Capacity
 - Cross-Functional Team
 - Silos



Organization Structure – Functional

One form of Hierarchical Organization Structure

- Employees organized by skill/specialty
- Each department managed independently
- Multiple layers of management



Pros

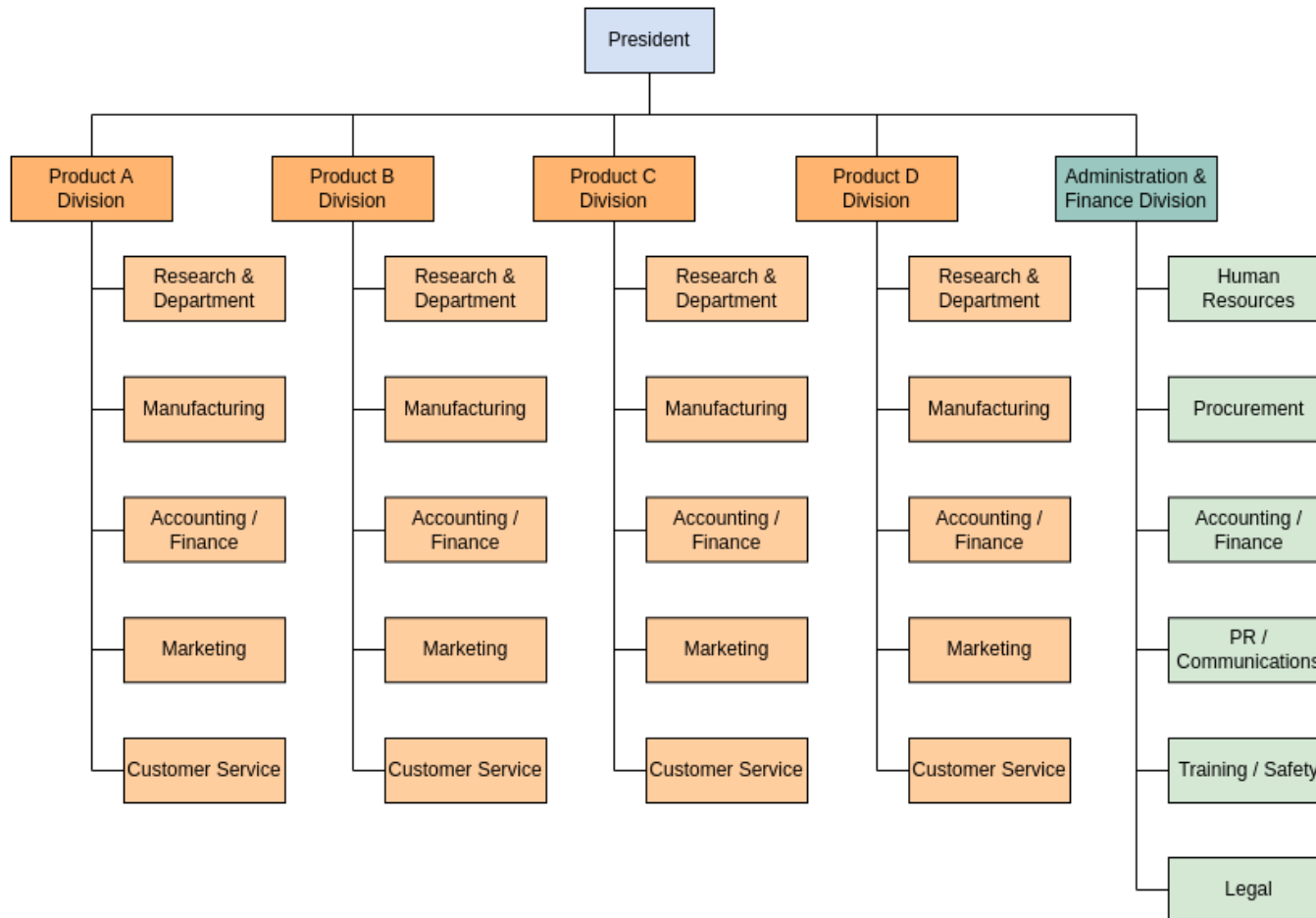
- Strong focus on role/specialty
- Narrow span of control
- Good for career path = motivating
- Clear accountability
- Easy to scale

Cons

- Many layers of management = long chain of command
- Communication challenging
- Can create silos between functions
- Higher costs (mgmt. salaries)
- Narrow perspective more common

Organization Structure – Divisional

- Common for very large companies
- Each division has their own dedicated resources
- Divisions can be separated by markets, products, geographies



Pros

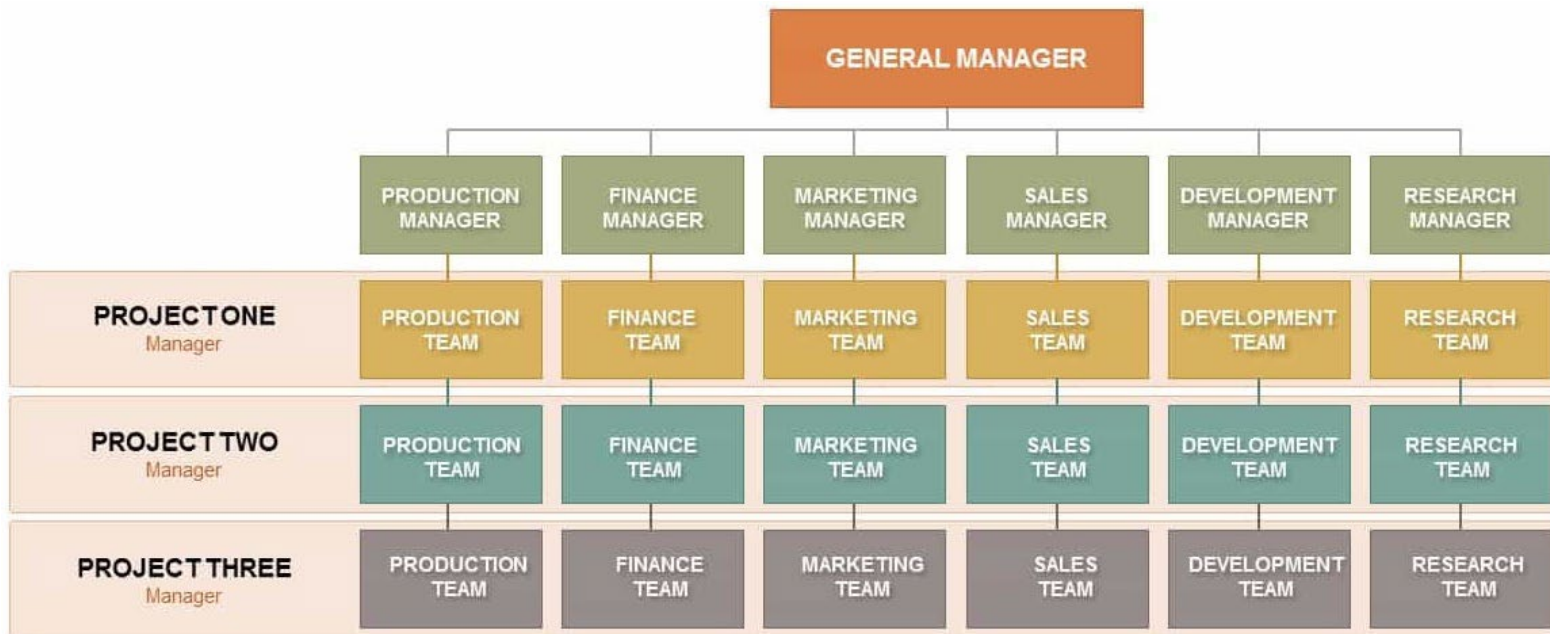
- Clear accountability for results
- Promotes Independence
- Good for career path/motivation
- Customer centric

Cons

- Duplicative resources likely
- Communication challenging
- Internal competition possible
- Inconsistent processes/Lack of standardization
- Corporate Brand can be challenged/confused

Organization Structure – Matrix

- Reporting structure setup as a grid
- Traditional functional departments on one axis
- Project teams along the other axis



Pros

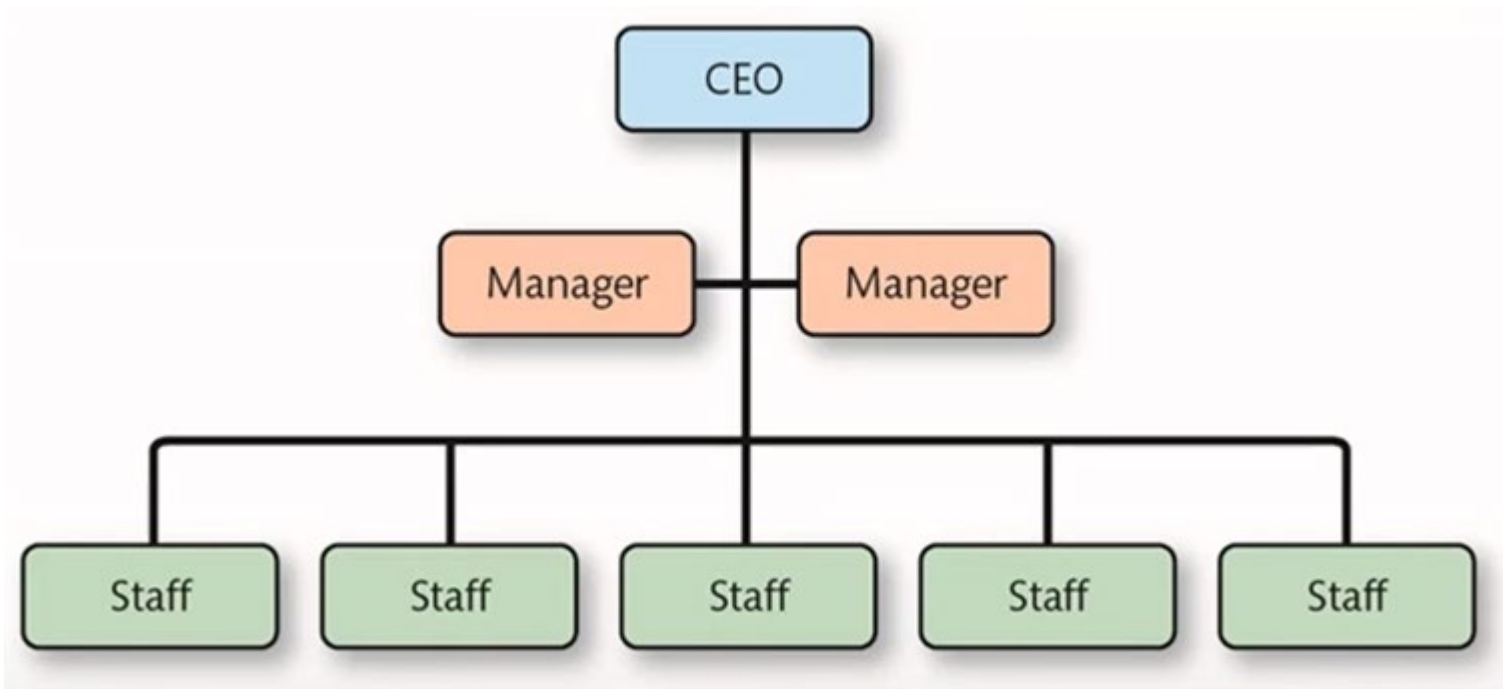
- Utilizes skills effectively / Maximizes expertise
- Efficient resource utilization
- Effective communication
- Increased morale/engagement
- Customer focus

Cons

- Dual-reporting causes confusion / power struggles
- Lack of accountability
- Slow decision-making
- Less flexible when workloads vary
- Tends to change frequently

Organization Structure – Flat

- Characterized by few or no layers of management
- Common among smaller or start-up businesses.



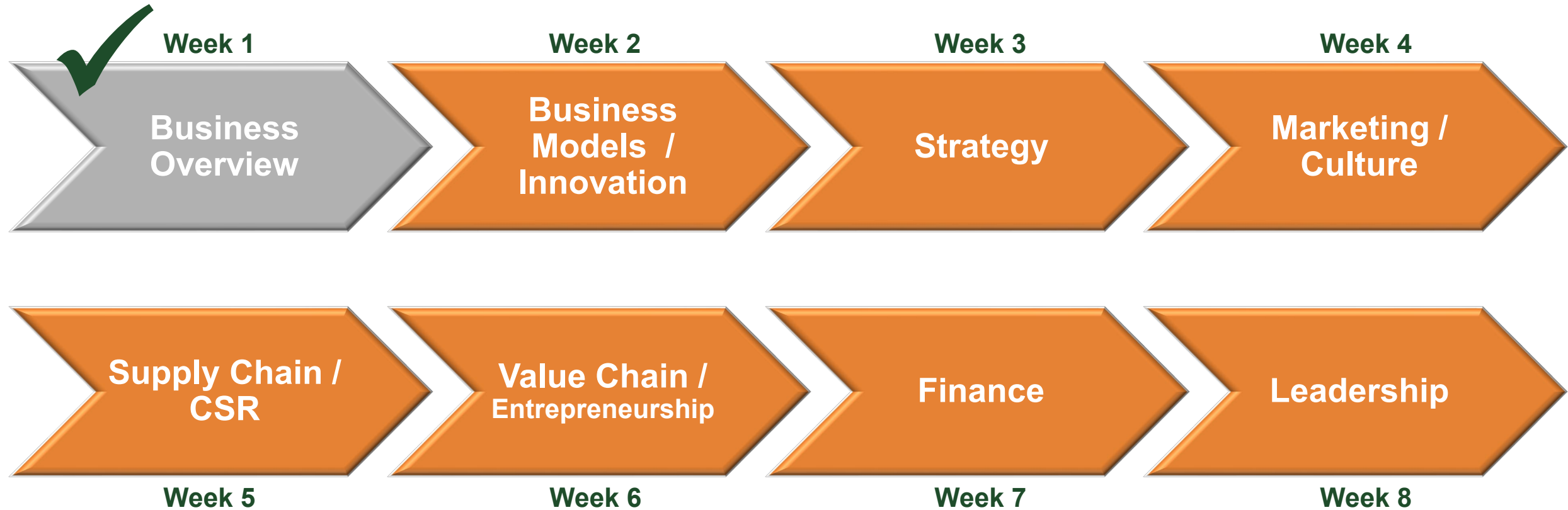
Pros

- Faster communication
- Faster decision making
- Engagement and empowerment
- Less costly (salaries)
- Flexibility

Cons

- Wide span of control / overburdened management
- No career path/promotions
- Power struggles
- Difficult to scale
- Risk of chaos

Course Outline



Homework

- Assignments (Due Sept 2*)

- Should have already completed
 - Copyright and Academic Integrity Form
 - Pre-class Quiz
- Personal Questionnaire
- Week 1 Quiz
- Business Profile Assignment
- Online Students: Discussion Topic #1 on Networking

- Reading for next week

- *From Good Ideas to Great Results: How to Speak Business and Make an Impact* by Josh Peterson
- *Stop the Innovation Wars* by V. Govindarajan and C. Trimble

*Refer to Canvas and course syllabus for due dates for online classes beyond Oct 18, 2026



Business Profile Assignment (BPA) Instructions

You will use this deck for this template for this week's assignment. You will turn in this PowerPoint file as your homework submission. With each subsequent assignment, please include the "Student Name" and "Business Profile – Overview" slides with your submission. Here are some points to remember when using this template:

- You must use the same company for all assignments. Preferably, this is the company you currently work for. However, if you are not working at the moment, or your company just doesn't work well for these assignments (i.e. government agencies, small volunteer organizations) then select a company in an industry that interests you or that you would like to work for.
- These assignments are built around the company you work for to maximize your ability to apply the content to a familiar context. However, it's a challenge for ICs that may not be as familiar with your organization. Provide additional detail, additional notes, or anything else that can help your IC grade the assignment either in slide notes or in additional slides.
- There are notes on each slide indicating which assignment that slide is a part of to make it easy for you to know when each slide needs to be completed. The slide notes may also contain additional instructions – make sure you read them!
- If additional space is necessary, you may insert additional slides and/or use the notes option, just make it clear to your IC that the content is continued on the next slide.

FILE NAMING

- Please follow the file naming convention below. This helps your IC find your assignment easily:
LASTNAME.FIRSTNAME.ASSIGNMENTNAME. Example: PORTER.MICHAEL.BPA



Assignment Grading Criteria

Business Profile Assignment Rubric

Criteria	Pts
Business Profile What's your elevator pitch? Be sure you provide sufficient detail for your IC to understand your business.	10 pts
Organization Structure Provide company organizational structure. Explain how your company is organized: is it a hierarchical organization? Flat organization? Does the organizational structure facilitate meeting your objectives? Why? Which functional areas are key to your organization's success and why?	35 pts
Stakeholders Who are some of the key stakeholders for your company? What are ways that they influence your organization? What are some examples of how they are critical to your organization's success?	35 pts
Total Points: 80	

Evaluation Criteria (from Course Syllabus)

Support Quality of Work:

- Each statement or explanation is supported by sound facts, logics, or data points.
- Analysis yields complex and nuanced syntheses of ideas, demonstrating true understanding.

Accurate Class Concept Use:

- Class concepts are used throughout the assignment in a manner that demonstrates a full understanding of the concept.

Critical Thinking:

- Exercises include data and reasoning that confirms or disconfirms the thesis.
- The analysis or explanation demonstrates an understanding of the uncertainty surrounding the facts, logics, and conclusions.

Mechanics and Professionalism:

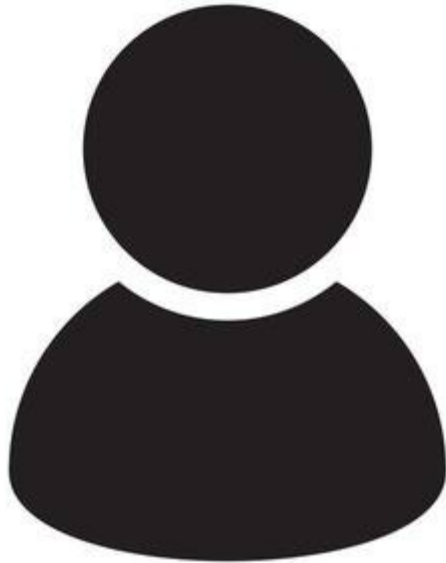
- Work is professionally presented and free from grammatical or typographical errors.
- Headings, images, figures, and tables are appropriately and effectively used.

WOW Factor:

- Approximately 10% of the total grade will be determined by the WOW factor. This is evidence of work that exceeds expectations. These points are reserved for those projects that go beyond assignment requirements and demonstrate creativity, extra effort, and refined professionalism.



Student Name



Student photo

- Insert student name here

(Please use the name you prefer your IC use for communication with you)





Business Profile – Overview

- Business name:
- Business website:
- Products/services:
- Target market(s)/customers:
- Top rivals/competitors:





Business Profile – Description

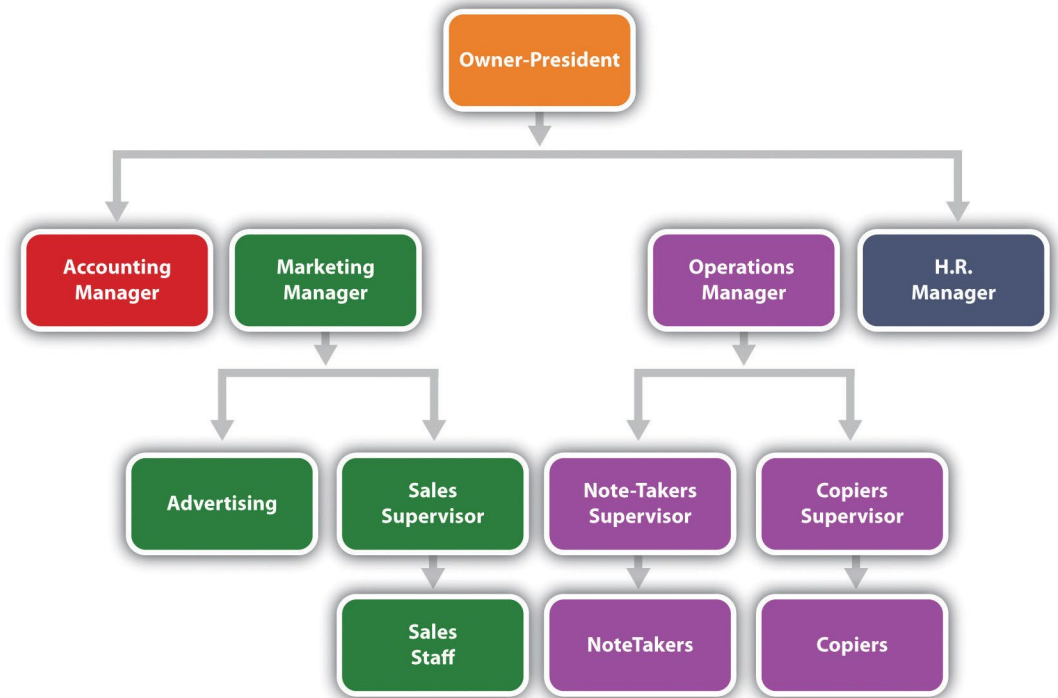
- Describe your business – what's your elevator pitch? Be sure you provide sufficient detail for your IC to understand your business.



Business Profile – Organization Structure

- Replace the organization chart on this slide with one that describes your company's structure.
- Explain how your company is organized: is it a hierarchical organization? Flat organization?
- Does the organizational structure facilitate meeting your objectives? Why?
- Which functional areas are key to your organization's success and why?

NOTE: The graphic can take the entire slide, and you can use the Slide Notes below to address the questions and provide explanations. You can also create additional slides if necessary.



Business Profile – Organizational Stakeholders

- Replace the graphic on this slide with one that names your company's **key** stakeholders.
- Who are some of the **key** stakeholders for your company?
- What are ways that they influence your organization?
- What are some examples of how they are critical to your organization's success?

NOTE: The graphic can take the entire slide, and you can use the Slide Notes below to address the questions and provide explanations. You can also create additional slides if necessary.



Thank You



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